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Despatch No. 39. Series 1867.

NAVY DEPARTMENT
JUL 13 1867
SEC. OFFICE

U. S. Flag Ship Hartford (2nd Rate)
Yokohama, Japan.
April 30th. 1867

Hon. Gideon Welles.
Secretary of the Navy.
Washington. D.C.

Sir.

I have the honour to make the following Monthly Report of the distribution, and employment, of the vessels of the U.S. Asiatic Squadron for the Month of April 1867.

The Flag Ship Hartford, Commander Belknap, sailed from Hong Kong, April 1st. for Yokohama, intending, as I informed the Department in my Despatch No. 27, dated March 31st 1867, to touch at Formosa. I was forced however, by heavy weather, to put into Amoy, upon the 4th Inst.

Sailing from Amoy upon the 9th of April

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April; I hove to off Tamsui, the most northern port of Formosa, on the 16th. Inst. for the purpose of communicating with Commander Jeliger of the Ashuelot, whom I had expected to meet there. From thence the Hartford proceeded to Yokohama, where She arrived on the 17th April, having broken the air pump of her after engine on the way, as reported in my Despatch No. 35, dated April 23d 1867. The repairs are being made with all dispatch and She will be ready for sea, about the 10th of May.

The Shenandoah, Captain Goldsborough, arrived at Yokohama on the 5th Instant, in Nine days from Hong Kong. On the 22d. Inst. I despatched the Shenandoah, accompanied by the Wyoming, to Yedo, there to Embark the United States Minister and his Suite, and to convey them to Osaka, as reported in my

No. 35, above referred to: These two vessels touched here on the Evening of the 27th. Inst. and Sailed for Osaka, yesterday Morning, the 29th Instant.

Captain Goldsborough has been instructed to Land the Minister under a Salute, and with an Escort of the five Marine Guards of the Shenandoah, and Wyoming, appropriate to the Occasion.

Upon my arrival at Amoy, on the 4th of April, Commander Broad R. N. Commanding H.B.M.'s S. Cormorant, informed me, that when at Takao, Island of Formosa, on the 22d of March, he heard that the American Bark Rover, Captain Hunt, had been Wrecked on the Vele. Rete Rocks, to the Southward of Formosa, that her Officers and crew, had taken to the boats, and that Captain Hunt, his wife, the Mate and three Chinamen, Landing in the Bay, on the South End of Formosa, were all Murdered, Except One Sailor a

Chinaman.

Chinaman, (the other boat having separated from the first boat in the night time), by the Wildmen who inhabit a part of the Island. These barbarians are said to be of most primitive habits, wearing no clothing, and occupying no habitations, but living in the mountains and thickets.

Commander Broad sent out Messengers to the Aboriginals, proposing to ransom the survivors of the crew of the Rover, if there he found any, and two days after, accompanied by Mr. Adams H.B.M's Consul, at Takao, proceeded in his vessel, to the place of the murder. Upon his attempting to land however, he was fired upon from the bushes, with muskets and bows and arrows, having one man wounded, whereupon he returned to his vessel, and shelled the bushes, and then returned to Amoy.

Upon receiving this information, I immediately despatched orders by Mail

Mail Steamer, then paying up, to Commander Ketziger of the Schuelot, then lying at Foochow, to visit the scene of the outrage, and to Endeavor to Rescue any Survivors, if by Chance there Should be any. I have not as yet received the Report of Commander Ketzigers movements in pursuance of his order. His Station remains the same as before Reported.

The Hartford could not perform this Service, Without being too Late for more pressing interests at Japan.

No further information of the movements of the Wachusett has been received from Commander Shufeldt, Since the date of my last Monthly Report, when She was in the Yang-Tze River, guarding the American Steamboats and Mercantile interests, against the Nanfi, or Robber bands; the Mandarins themselves, Soliciting Commander Shufeldts Apistance.

The Monocacy, was in Dock at

at Whampoa, cleaning and painting her Bottom on the 18th. April, and upon Coming Out Way to visit Canton and Macao, and to Cruize to the Westward of Hong Kong, to guard the interests of our Countrymen, & suppress Piracies, and the Coolie Traffic by our Citizens.

The Wyoming Lieut. Commander Carpenter, Commanding, Was at this Port, until the 22d. Inst, Since which time, her movements have been as described above in connection with those of the Shenandoah.

The Store Ship Supply, A.V.S. Commander Conroy, Commanding, was to leave Hong Kong, On the 8th of April, for Shanghai, there to Supply the Wachusett, with Provisions and Stores, after which, She will proceed to Nagasaki, where She will provision the Wyoming, and will be stationed there for the present, to Supply vessels Employed in the

North.

I am glad to be able to report that the health of the Squadron, continues Excellent. The only death reported during the month, is that of James Kop. (O.S.) of the Shenandoah, who was drowned at Yedo, on the 24th April, by the capsizing of a boat.

I have the Honor to be Sir
Very Respectfully
Your Obedient Servant
H H Bell
Rear Admiral
Comdg. U.S. Asiatic Squadron

Despatch No: 40. Series 1867.

NAVY DEPARTMENT
DESPATCH
JUL 13 1867
SEC. OFFICE

U. S. Flag Ship "Hartford" (2d Rate)
Yokohama Japan.
May 10th. 1867.

Hon. Gideon Welles.
Secretary of the Navy.
Washington City D.C.

Sir.

I have the honour to inform the Department that a Board of Medical Survey having found First Lieutenant Edouard L. Gabaudan of the U.S. Marine Corps, attached to the U.S.S. Hartford, unfit for Duty, and the Board having recommended, that, "he be sent to the United States, by the Earliest, and most direct opportunity; I have this day detached Lieutenant Gabaudan from the Hartford, and I have ordered him to proceed to New-York, in the Pacific Mail Steam Ship Company's Steamer, Colorado, via San Francisco, and

Rear Admiral
Commdg Asiatic Squadron
Yokohama
Japan.
April 30. 1867.

Monthly Report of
Discipline and
Employment of Vessels,
Asiatic Squadron,
for
April 1867.

Asiatic Sqn - Flagg